Calvin Li

Seattle, WA

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Backend software engineer focused on data services with high throughput and high availability, including systems with billions of daily requests at 99.99% uptime. Skilled in building for reliability and leading globally distributed teams. Demonstrated leadership as tech lead across multiple projects, consistently enabling overseas developers to deliver on time. Experienced across the full development lifecycle, from design and planning to coding and on-call.

Programming Languages and Technologies

Python | Google Cloud | Terraform | DevOps | ETL | Git | Datadog | Copilot Chat | Kubernetes | Kotlin | C# | AWS | Kafka | Typescript

Work Experience

Zonar Systems Inc, Senior SDE, Data Services Team **09/24 - 09/26, Seattle WA**

- Primary maintainer for our internal routing service. Tuned Datadog and PagerDuty to eliminate false P1 alerts and secured cloud capacity to prevent peak backlogs in our 500M msgs/day system.
- Assumed on-call maintenance for over a dozen legacy side projects. Kept systems live and shipped required updates, often without original developers.
- Built Kafka ingestion for a vendor dashcam event stream processing 10M messages a day, filtering safety events from routine telemetry for downstream enrichment.
- Orchestrated driver-vehicle association sync, streaming 5,000 driver asset assignments per day from GCP to AWS Kinesis via Apache Beam, unifying fleet visibility across clouds.
- Leveraged Copilot Chat (Claude) to deliver an Apigee gateway with zero prior platform experience. Estimated 75% reduction in setup time versus comparable past work.

Zonar Systems Inc, Tech Lead, OCI Team **09/24 - 09/26, Remote (Vietnam)**

- Coordinated global communications and JIRA sprint planning for an eight-person overseas development team, maintaining on-time project delivery at an estimated 25% of the cost.
- Directed a third-party integration for 10,000 dashcams recording safety events and driver associations, absorbing frequent requirement shifts to secure an on-time launch.
- Managed the certification of Zonar hardware across three CARB-CTC protocols, automating mandatory emissions checks while reducing costs by up to 80%.

Zonar Systems Inc, Tech Lead, Vietnam Support Team **09/24 - 09/25, Remote (Vietnam)**

- Led an eight-person off-hours support team providing on-call coverage and 99.9% uptime for 10 Vietnam-based contractor teams.
- Instilled a "false positives over false negatives" incident culture on the team. Traveled onsite to coach and eliminated false negatives entirely.

Zonar Systems Inc, Senior SDE, Gateway Integrations team **03/23 - 09/24, Seattle WA**

- Diagnosed and triaged customer-facing issues during Light Duty TCU field tests and beta trials. Worked with customer care and firmware teams to root-cause issues within eight hours.
- Led harsh event detection for LDTCU. Owned the end-to-end translation of raw sensor data into harsh acceleration/turning/braking events with minimal false positives.
- Mentored a summer intern through a successful PubSub-to-BigQuery PoC that became production infrastructure, still in use today.
- Co-organized the company-wide hackathon to foster in-person cross-team collaboration following reopening of the office.

Zonar Systems Inc, Software Engineer II, OEM team **03/20 - 03/23, Seattle WA**

- Built LDTCU's odometer estimation system, stack-ranking speed and GPS to bypass OBD stop-only odometer data. Added telemetry to track method accuracy over time.
- Co-developed the OEM Platform, creating a generic ingestion framework that reduced time for onboarding new data sources from months to weeks.
- Transitioned legacy on-prem OEM services onto the OEM Platform, eliminating boilerplate and enabling full decommissioning of physical infrastructure.

Zume Inc, Software Engineer, Packaging **11/19 - 01/20, Seattle WA**

- Worked on web app for tracking production at packaging factory

Microsoft Corporation, Software Engineer, Microsoft Graph REST API **08/17 - 06/19, Redmond WA**

- Resolved production issues for Microsoft Graph's US DoD deployment under restricted access, and coordinating with cleared personnel for live-system diagnostics.
- Delivered feature work and on-call coverage for Microsoft Graph at the scale of billions of daily requests, maintaining 99.99% uptime.

Microsoft Corporation, Software Engineer, Azure AD Graph REST API **06/16 - 08/17, Redmond WA**

- Implemented publisher domain verification for applications in the AAD Graph REST API, validating domain ownership via a well-known file check to enable secure app consent prompts.
- Automated the legacy SDK pipeline (updates, versioning, signing), slashing publish time from hours to minutes.

Education

University of California, Davis
Bachelor of Science Computer Science, Master of Science Computer Science

Software Engineer Intern, Microsoft Authenticator App, 6/2015 - 9/2015

- Added fingerprint authentication and Apple Watch integration, reducing time needed to authenticate by up to 80% without compromising security.

Personal Projects

Quest
github.com/calvin-li/Quest

- Android app I made to help me track tasks using the notification system
- Source code on Github, also on the Play Store